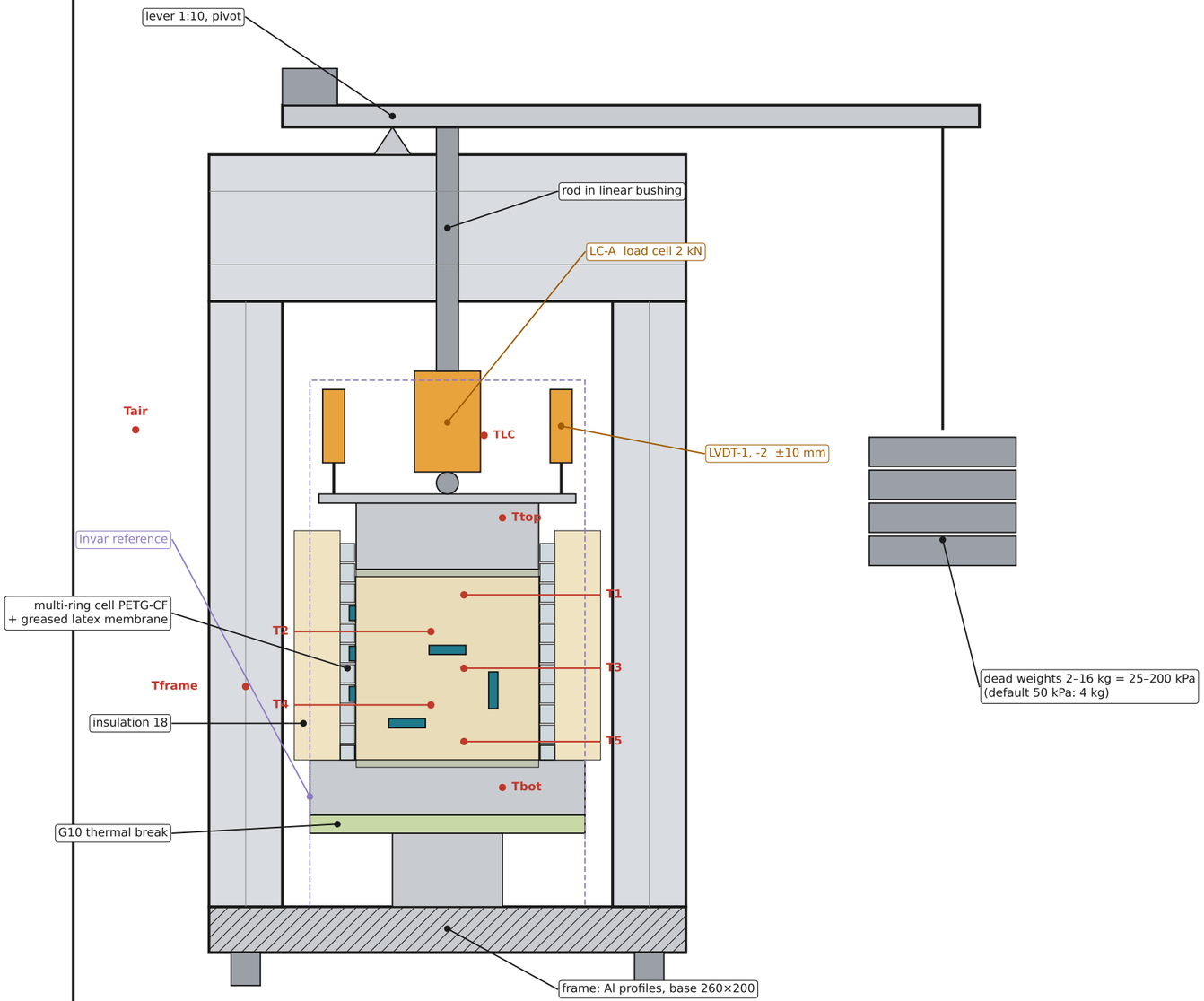
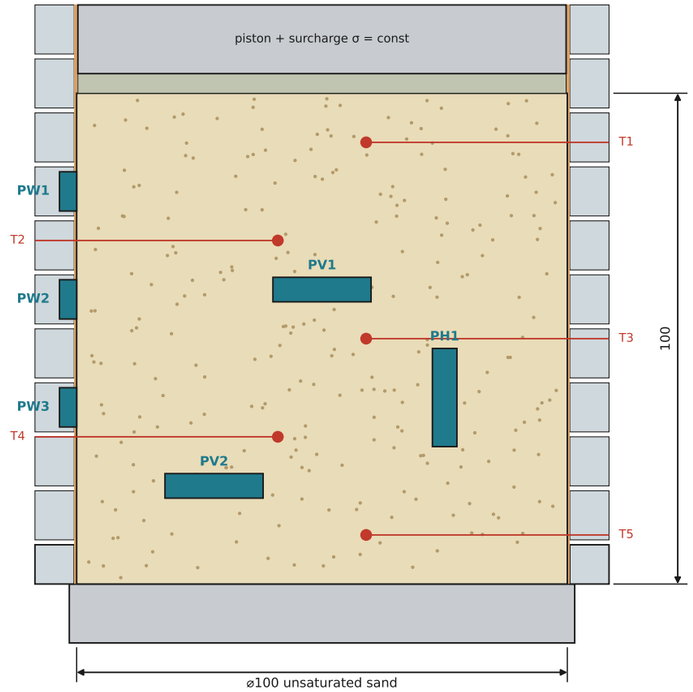


Sensors (tag → model → CR1000)

tag	measures	recommended model	CR1000
LC-A	applied load	Interface SSM 2 kN	DIFF1, BrFull, VX1
PV1, PV2	vertical stress in sand	TBD	MUX-1 (4×16), BrFull
PH1	radial stress in sand	TBD	MUX-1 (4×16), BrFull
PW1…PW3	lateral stress on wall	TBD	MUX-1 (4×16), BrFull
LVDT-1,2	check: no movement	RDP DCTH400	DIFF4–7, VoltDiff ±5 V
T1…T5	soil, r 9 mm	Campbell 109SS	AM16/32B → SE15, VX2
Ttop, Tbot	piston, pedestal	Campbell 109SS	(same)
TLC, Tframe, Tair	load cell, frame, air	Campbell 109SS / 107	AM16/32B → SE15, VX2

How it works
Unsaturated sand (Sr ≈ 0.3–0.5) freezes and thaws under a constant surcharge from the lever (10× the dead weight). The surcharge keeps the sand in place; the LVDTs confirm it does not move (expected < 0.1 mm). Embedded cells measure vertical (PV) and radial (PH) stress inside the sand, wall sensors (PW) the lateral stress; the rise above the surcharge during freezing is the pressure generated by ice in the pores.
Cells are calibrated in sand under dead weight at −10 and +10 °C first.

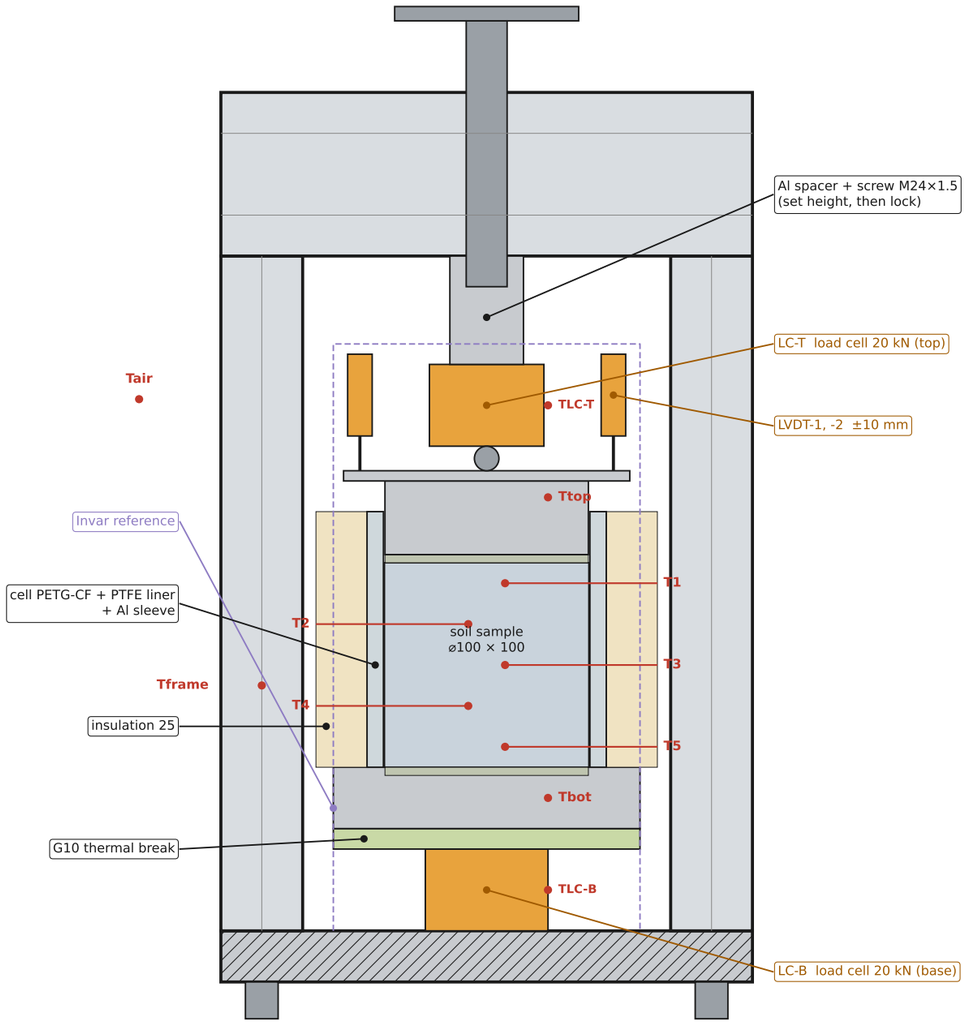
DETAIL – sand, pressure sensors, thermistors ≈ 1 : 1.25



schematic; orange = force / displacement, blue = pressure, red = temperature; cells revolved into section

Variant A – unsaturated sand, surcharge, internal pressures

status	DRAFT	drawn	Claude Code (draft)	checked: —
units	mm	project	E7 – freeze–thaw loading tests	date 2026-10-20
scale	≈ 1 : 3	drawing no.	**E7-V01**	sheet 1 / 6



Sensors (tag → model → CR1000)

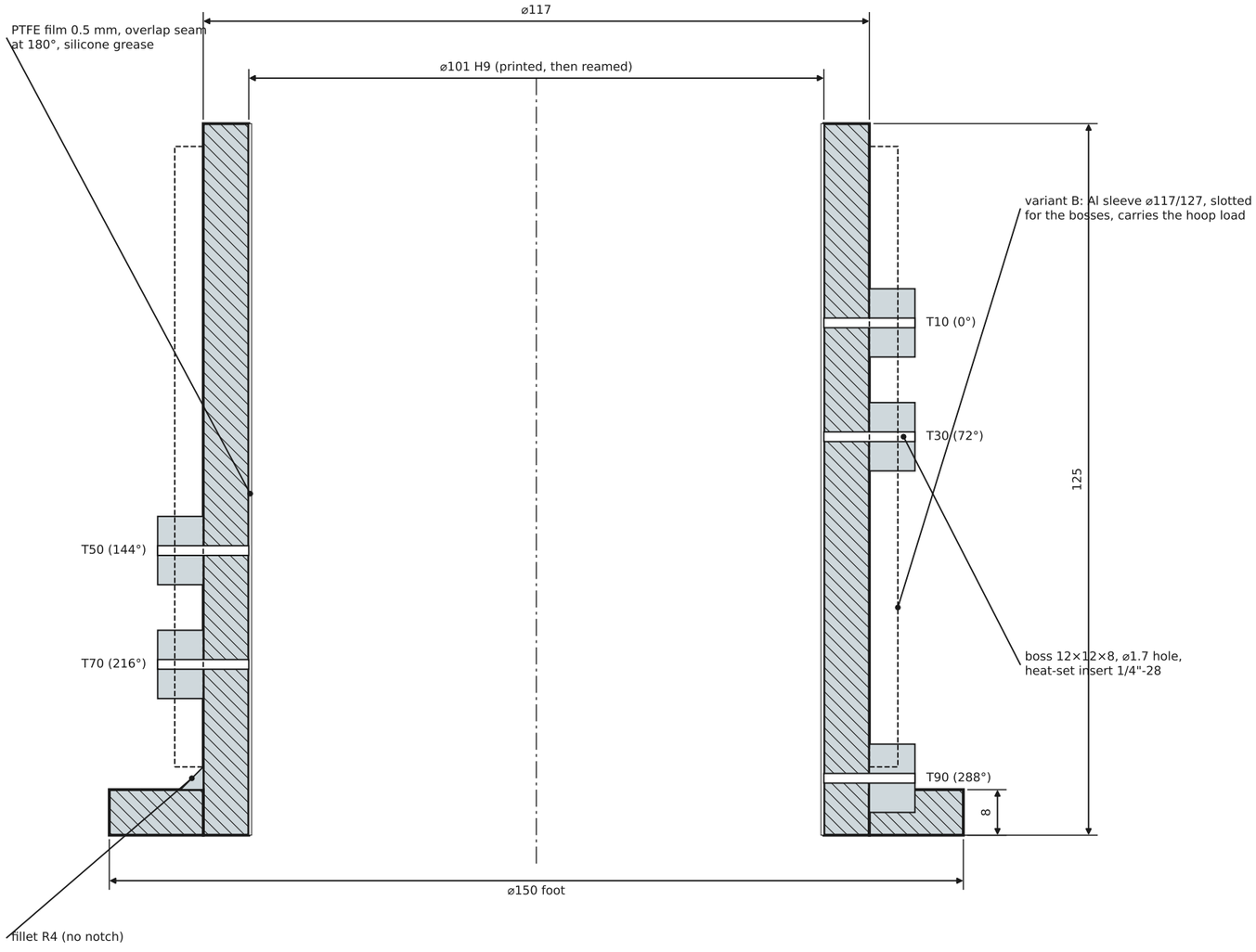
tag	measures	recommended model	CR1000
LC-T	heave force, top	HBM C9C/20kN	DIFF2, BrFull, VX1
LC-B	force at base	HBM C9C/20kN	DIFF3, BrFull, VX1
LVDT-1,2	residual movement	RDP DCTH400	DIFF4–7, VoltDiff ±5 V
T1…T5	soil, r 9 mm	Campbell 109SS	AM16/32B → SE15, VX2
Ttop, Tbot	piston, pedestal	Campbell 109SS	(same)
TLC-T/B, Tframe, Tair	load cells, frame, air	Campbell 109SS / 107	AM16/32B → SE15, VX2

How it works
The screw holds the piston at constant height; the soil pushes against it while freezing. LC-T measures that force, LC-B the force arriving at the base – the difference is the friction on the cell wall. The LVDTs show how much the frame still gives (report the stiffness with the pressure).
Run a blank test with an Al dummy to remove the effect of the frame shrinking in the cold (vypocty.md §3).

schematic, proportions to scale; sensors in orange (force, displacement) and red (temperature)

Variant B – constant height (simplified)

status	DRAFT	drawn	Claude Code (draft)	checked: —
units	mm	project	E7 – freeze–thaw loading tests	date 2026-10-20
scale	**≈ 1 : 3**	drawing no.	**E7-V02**	sheet 2 / 6



Material check – PETG-CF

load case	stress	SF short	SF long
hoop stress, A 200 kPa	1.3 MPa	> 30	> 9
hoop stress, B 1 MPa	6.3 MPa	6–9	1.9–2.6
hoop stress, B 2 MPa	12.6 MPa	3–4	1.0–1.3
hoop, B 2 MPa + Al sleeve 5 mm	≈ 1 MPa*	> 40	> 12
axial (Z), friction μ 0.5, 1 MPa	5.8 MPa	2.6–5	< 1.6
axial (Z), PTFE μ 0.05, 1 MPa	0.6 MPa	> 25	> 7

Assumed strength (data-sheet range, verify): XY 40–55 MPa, Z 15–30 MPa, E 3–6 GPa; long-term limit ≈ 30 % (creep, layer bond). Details: vypocty.md §4.

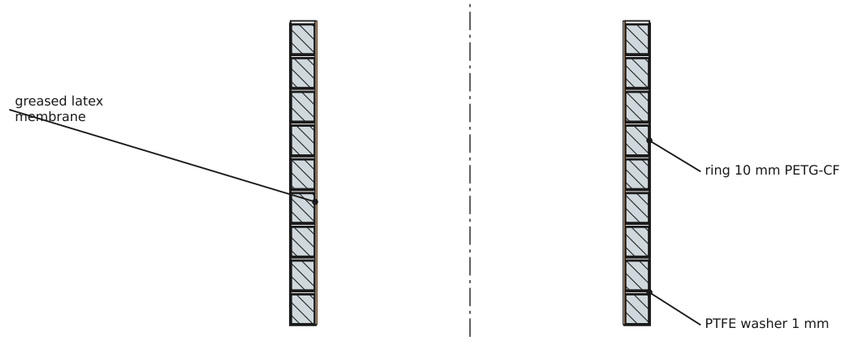
Verdict: suitable for variant A; for B (design 2 MPa) only with the Al sleeve shown dashed (*it carries ≈ 90 % of the hoop load: 70 GPa×5 mm vs. ≈ 4 GPa×8 mm), the PETG-CF then acts as a liner.
Conditions for both:
- the wall is ≥ 8 mm and printed with concentric perimeters only (100 % infill, no zig-zag), so the hoop stress runs along the filament;
- friction is kept low (PTFE liner) and the cell is not clamped at the foot, so friction pushes the wall instead of pulling the layers apart;
- the inside is sealed (thin epoxy coat) so water cannot enter print voids and split layers when it freezes;
- there are no printed threads or sharp notches (CF lowers toughness at −10 °C) – heat-set inserts and fillets instead.

Variant A: a multi-ring cell (view F) is the literature standard against wall friction – printed rings 10 mm + PTFE washers + greased latex.

Print settings (starting point)
hardened nozzle 0.6 mm, layer 0.2 mm, 250–260 °C, bed 80 °C, slow outer walls, filament dried 4 h at 65 °C, enclosure, part cooling ≤ 30 %.

Qualification before use
1 ring burst test: printed ring 20 mm high, internal water pressure to failure (target ≥ 3× design pressure);
2 10 freeze–thaw cycles −10/+10 °C of water-saturated coupons, then tensile test XY and Z vs. dry control;
3 creep: ring under 1 MPa for 7 days at +10 °C, hoop strain gauge.

VIEW F – multi-ring cell (variant A) 1 : 2

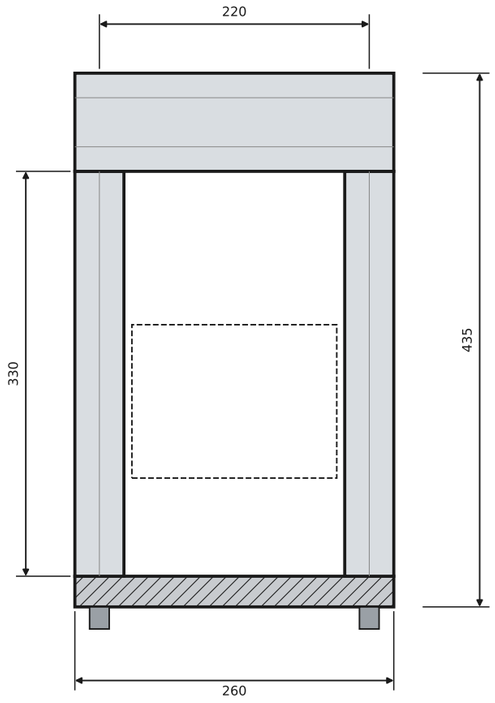


print upright; hoop direction = layer direction; foot rests on the pedestal, not bolted

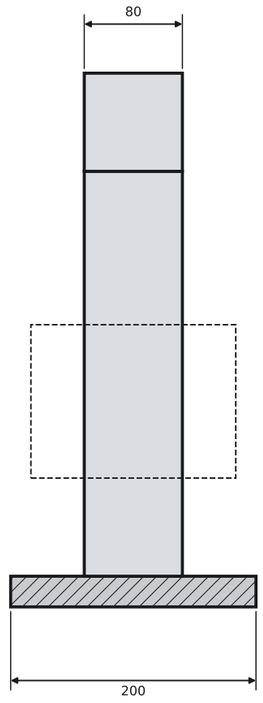
Sample cell – PETG-CF, 3D printed

status	DRAFT	drawn	Claude Code (draft)	checked: —
units	mm	project	E7 – freeze–thaw loading tests	date 2026-10-20
scale	**1 : 1**	drawing no.	**E7-V03**	sheet 3 / 6

FRONT VIEW 1 : 5



SIDE VIEW 1 : 5



Bill of materials

#	part	size	qty
1	base plate Al 6082 T6	260 × 200 × 25	1
2	profile 40×80 (column)	l = 330	2
3	profile 80×80 (cross-beam)	l = 260	1
4	core bolt M12 into tapped profile end		8
5	socket screw M10 base → column end		4
6	levelling foot M12, steel		3
7	Invar rod ⌀10 + Invar/Al bridge (LVDT)	l = 300	2 + 1
8	linear ball bushing ⌀16 (A) / nut M24×1.5 (B)	in cross-beam	1
9	end caps, T-slot covers		–

Profile values used in vypocty.md §2 are typical catalogue values (series 8): 40×80 A ≈ 1050 mm², 80×80 I ≈ 1.4·10⁶ mm⁴ – check against the chosen supplier.

Stiffness at 15.7 kN (2 MPa): cross-beam 0.036 mm, columns 0.035 mm, load cell ≈ 0.05 mm, joints 0.02–0.15 mm. Joints dominate → core bolts into tapped profile ends, torque-controlled, no angle brackets; optionally 2 steel tie rods M12 next to the cell.

Fit in the chest freezer: frame 260 × 200, height 435 mm incl. base; two rigs side by side on the tray; variant A lever 390 mm long, ≈ 30 mm above the beam – layout and heights on E7-V06.

one frame for both variants; core-bolted joints, no angle brackets in the load path

Frame – aluminium profiles

status	DRAFT	drawn	Claude Code (draft)	checked: —
units	mm	project	E7 – freeze–thaw loading tests	date 2026-10-20
scale	**1 : 5**	drawing no.	**E7-V04**	sheet 4 / 6

Options per measurement (PICK = recommended)

sensor	maker / model	key specs	verdict
LC 2 kN	Interface SSM 2 kN	comp. −15…+65 °C, op. −55…+90 °C, IP67	PICK
LC 2 kN	HBM S9M/2kN	class 0.02, 2 mV/V, 6-wire, IP68, nom. −10…+70 °C	alternative
LC 2 kN	HBM U2B 2 kN	class 0.1, 2 mV/V, IP67, temp. [U]	alternative
LC 2 kN	ME KD80s 2 kN	2 mV/V, 0.2 mm at FS, −10…+70 °C	alternative
LC 2 kN	Lorenz K-25	1–2 mV/V, IP67, ext. range on request	ask quote
LC 2 kN	AML DBBSM	comp. only 0…+70 °C, IP51	not suitable
LC 20 kN	HBM C9C/20kN	⌀26×13 mm, 1 mV/V, nom. −10…+70, op. −30…+85 °C	PICK
LC 20 kN	Burster 8402 20 kN	1.5 mV/V, ≤ 50 µm deflection, op. −30…+100 °C, IP54	alternative
LC 20 kN	HBM C10 25 kN	class 0.02–0.05, height 36 mm [U]	alternative
LC 20 kN	Futek LTH500 (≈22 kN)	donut, 0.05 mm, op. −50…+93 °C	alternative
LC 20 kN	Interface LBM	comp. only +21…+77 °C	not suitable
LVDT ±10	RDP DCTH400	±5 V / 0–10 V out, −40…+80 °C, ±0.25 % FS	PICK
LVDT ±10	Micro-Epsilon DTA-10D + MSC7401	0–5 V / 4–20 mA, −20…+80 °C	alternative
LVDT ±10	Solartron AX/10/S + OD5	±5 V out, needs 230 V conditioner	alternative
LVDT ±10	HBM WA-L 20 mm	passive, needs carrier amplifier	alternative
LVDT ±10	TE DC-EC 500	operating only 0…+70 °C	not suitable
T probe	Campbell 109SS	⌀1.6 mm, ±0.38 °C at 0 °C, direct on CR1000	PICK
T probe	Campbell 107	⌀7.6 mm, ±0.2 °C (0–50 °C)	air / frame
T probe	TE/YSI 44031 bead	±0.1 °C, own half bridge needed	for 0.01 °C (E6 chain)
T probe	Pt100 1/10 DIN + 4WPB100	2 DIFF + VX per sensor	too many channels

CR1000 channel plan

terminal	connected to	measurement
DIFF1	LC-A (rig A)	BrFull, ±7.5 mV, reversal
DIFF2	LC-T (rig B)	BrFull, ±2.5 mV (1 mV/V), reversal
DIFF3	LC-B (rig B)	BrFull, ±2.5 mV, reversal
VX1	excitation, 3 load cells	2500 mV, ≈ 21 mA
DIFF4, 5	LVDT-A1, A2	VoltDiff ±5000 mV, reversal, averaging
DIFF6, 7	LVDT-B1, B2	VoltDiff ±5000 mV, reversal, averaging
SE15 (DIFF8)	AM16/32B COM	2×32 mode, 21 thermistors (BrHalf / Therm109)
VX2	thermistor excitation	via AM16/32B
C1, C2	AM16/32B reset, clock	
12V, G	AM16/32B power	LVDTs: own ±15 V supply, common to AG
SE16, VX3	spare	e.g. panel check / 4WPB100

Channel count (2 rigs): 3 load cells + 4 LVDTs + 21 thermistors.
16 SE / 8 DIFF on the CR1000 → thermistors through the AM16/32B (2×32).

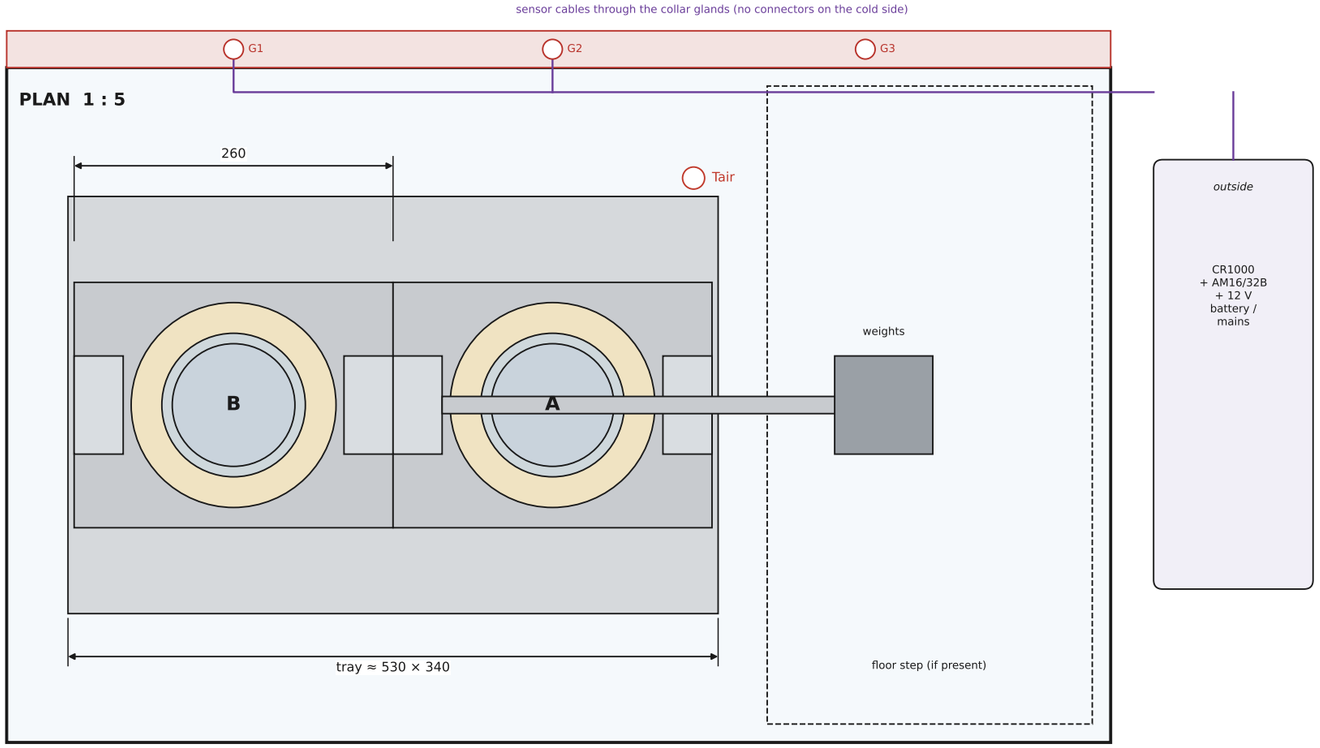
Resolution with the CR1000 (13-bit ADC)
- LC-A 2 mV/V, 2.5 V: 5 mV FS → ≈ 0.3 N ≈ 0.04 kPa
- LC-T/B 1 mV/V: 2.5 mV FS → ≈ 2.6 N ≈ 0.3 kPa
- LVDT ±5 V over ±10 mm: ≈ 1.3 µm (0.7 µm with reversal); absolute linearity ±0.25 % FS ≈ ±50 µm → calibrate with a micrometer
- 109SS: ±0.38 °C at 0 °C; ice-point offset check improves it

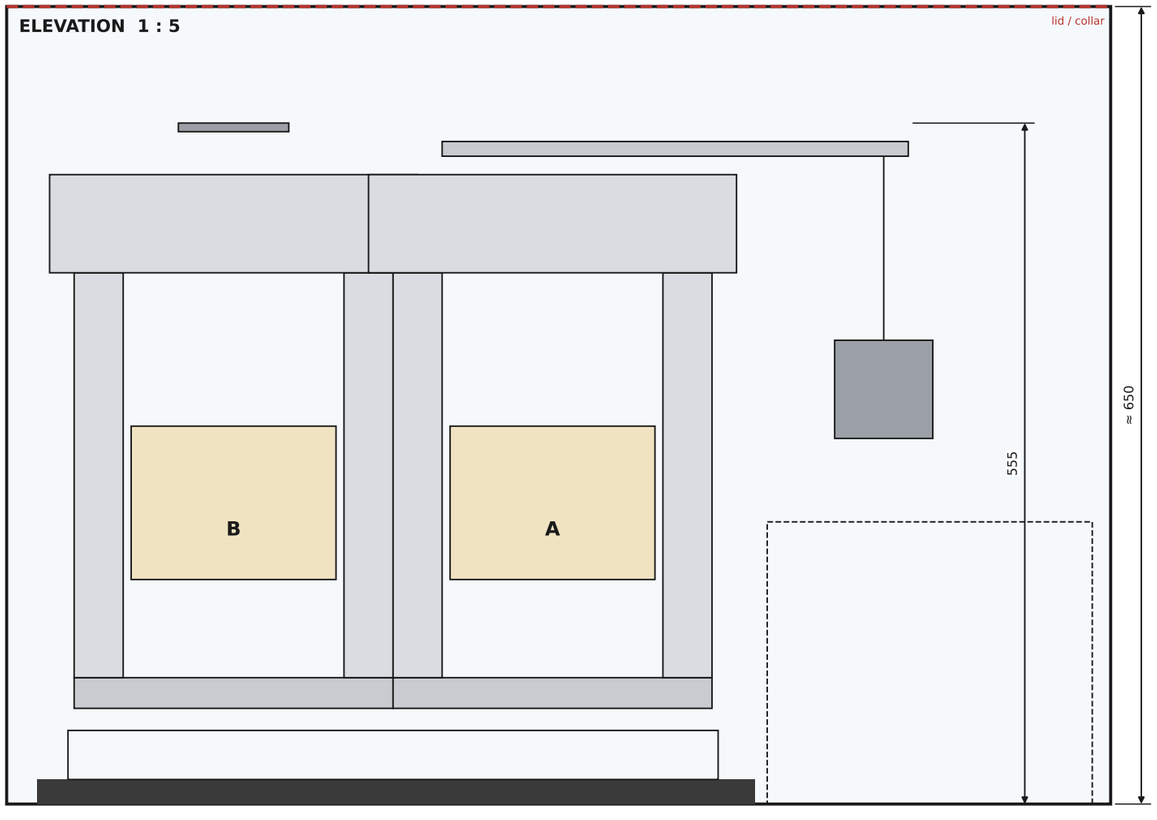
Notes
- CR1000 is discontinued (successor CR1000X / CR1000Xe, 24-bit); the existing one is fine for these resolutions.
- Logger outside the freezer (CR1000 −25…+50 °C).
- No load cell found with compensation to −20/−30 °C as standard: Interface SSM −15 °C, HBM −10 °C (op. −30 °C) – log TLC and correct; Interface/Lorenz offer extended ranges on request.
- 4WFBS modules are for quarter bridges – not needed here.

both rigs on one CR1000 + AM16/32B; models from manufacturer data (see README §7)

Sensor selection and CR1000 wiring

status	DRAFT	drawn	Claude Code (draft)	checked: —
units	mm	project	E7 – freeze–thaw loading tests	date 2026-10-20
scale	–	drawing no.	**E7-V05**	sheet 5 / 6





Fit check

item	size	limit	status
base plates 2 × 260 × 200	520 × 200	tray ≈ 530 × 340	OK (tight)
lever A along +x	hanger at x ≈ 715	over floor step	check step height
highest point	555 mm	inside ≈ 650	OK, measure
logger	outside, 0…+40 °C	CR1000 −25…+50 °C	keep warm & dry

Notes
- Both rigs share the freezer program (Set A) and the CR1000; each rig has its own Tair sensor at sample mid-height and its own load cell temperatures.
- Rig B stands at the closed side so the screw can be reached from above; rig A's lever points to the free end of the freezer.
- Run the blank test with Al dummies in both rigs before the first soil run.
- Dimensions marked ≈ are estimates from the photos (E6) – please measure.

same freezer as E6 (inside ≈ 900 × 550 × 650, to be measured); logger outside

Both rigs in the chest freezer + CR1000

status	DRAFT	drawn	Claude Code (draft)	checked: —
units	mm	project	E7 – freeze–thaw loading tests	date 2026-10-20
scale	**1 : 5**	drawing no.	**E7-V06**	sheet 6 / 6